DAYLON ROCK

IT Infrastructure and Support Specialist | Servers and Microsoft 365

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South Africa, relocating to New Zealand with immigration support.

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am an IT infrastructure and end user support specialist with over 20 years of experience. For almost 12 years I supported the servers, virtual machines, backup, network and security systems of a battery manufacturer, and its Microsoft 365 users. I joined SPAR in May 2023 as a Network Administrator and now support over 350 users across desktop, network and RF equipment, with a 96% first-contact resolution rate. I am seeking a long-term IT infrastructure or support role in New Zealand with an employer able to support my relocation.

CAREER GOALS

I want to bring my server, network, backup and end user support experience to a New Zealand organisation that values reliable service delivery. I hold AZ-900, am working towards AZ-104 (expected December 2026) and plan to grow into systems administration and cloud support.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Server Administration | Hyper-V and VMware | Backup and Recovery | Active Directory Microsoft 365 | Microsoft Entra ID | LAN and Wi-Fi | Endpoint Security | Incident Resolution | IT Asset Management | Technical Training | Project Delivery | Team Mentoring

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Servers and Cloud: on-premises servers (physical and virtual, Hyper-V, VMware), Active Directory, Microsoft 365, Microsoft Entra ID, Intune, AS400 systems.
- Backup, Security and Networking: Acronis, StorageCraft, ESET, Mimecast, Qualys-identified vulnerabilities, network failover testing.
- IT Support: hardware provisioning, Windows 11, incident resolution, asset management, RF equipment, training.
- Business Applications: CRM Dynamics, warehouse systems, Google AI, SAP PO creation, Microsoft Teams, Outlook, SharePoint.

WORK EXPERIENCE

End User Computing Support Specialist *2025 - Present*

The SPAR Group Ltd, Port Elizabeth, South Africa

- Provide first-line support at the distribution centre for desktops, laptops, mobile devices, RF equipment, and connectivity, resolving logged calls against service level targets.

- Set up new hardware to SPAR standards, transfer and test data when replacing equipment, oversee backup requirements and train users where required.

Network Administrator *May 2023 - 2025*

The SPAR Group Ltd, Port Elizabeth, South Africa

- Responsible for daily monitoring of servers and systems for availability, audit housekeeping procedures, user accounts, and Active Directory.
- Responsible for checking daily backup status, securing backup media, and keeping servers, workstations and laptops protected with current anti-virus software.
- Assisted with Qualys-identified vulnerabilities, took part in after-hours failover testing, produced monthly reports and coached desktop administrators.

Key achievements at SPAR (May 2023 to present)

- Achieved a 96% first-contact resolution rate for hardware and software issues across more than 350 users, consistently exceeding the support SLA.
- Delivered a warehouse site migration, installing all PCs and printers myself; completed one week ahead of schedule with minimal downtime.
- Configured workstations and provisioned accounts so new hires were operational on day one, and reduced wastage by 10% through proactive maintenance of onsite desktop equipment.
- Mentored IT interns and recommended improvements to the internship programme.

Customer Engineer (outsourced at AutoX Battery Manufacturing) *Sep 2011 - Apr 2023*

Technology Corporate Management, Port Elizabeth, South Africa

- Supported physical servers, virtual machines (Hyper-V and VMware) and the site LAN and Wi-Fi network; managed backup and disaster recovery using Acronis and StorageCraft.
- Administered ESET endpoint security and Mimecast email security, and deployed ESET to approximately two hundred endpoints with minimal disruption to business operations.
- Handled user provisioning and Microsoft 365 licensing as the primary end user support contact; delivered hybrid-work training that increased productivity by 20% and helped set up a training centre.
- Managed procurement, asset records, and vendors, and supported factory scanners, printers, and boardroom AV.
- Prepared infrastructure for a new factory, finishing two weeks ahead of schedule, and implemented a warehouse scanning solution that reduced manual processes by 40%.

PREVIOUS WORK EXPERIENCE SNAPSHOT

Customer Engineer, Edgetech Systems, Port Elizabeth *Jun 2006 - Aug 2011*

I created a monthly health check list for AS400 systems that improved uptime by 15% and delivered deskside and remote support with incidents logged and tracked through the internal ticketing system.

IT Technician (Part-time Contract), Inzuzu IT Consulting, East London *Jun 2003 - Nov 2005*

I led a team of 3 on desktop replacement rollouts across multiple South African Police Service (SAPS) sites, using route planning that kept each rollout ahead of schedule.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

AZ-104 Microsoft Azure Administrator, Microsoft (expected completion Dec 2026) 2026
AZ-900 Microsoft Azure Fundamentals, Microsoft 2026
Google AI Professional, Coursera 2026
Communicating with Impact; Embracing Change; Fostering Innovation; High Impact Feedback and Listening, Development Dimensions International 2025
CompTIA Network+ (issued 2012, expired), CompTIA 2012
Microsoft Certified Desktop Support Professional, Microsoft 2008
CompTIA A+ 2007
BCom Marketing and Business Management, Damelin, South Africa 2007

Preparing to relocate to New Zealand. Currently working with a Licensed Immigration Adviser at New Zealand Shores. Contact: vanessa@newzealandshores.com or +64 7 929 2280